

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Vow of the Noble Maitreya'

Ārya Maitri Pratijñā Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 643 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བརྒྱུས་པས་དམ་བཅས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་བྱང་ཆུབ་སྒྲུབ་པ།

Toh 643 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Maitri Pratijñā Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow of the Noble Maitreya." As its title indicates, it is a ritual dhāraṇī scripture centered on the bodhisattva Maitreya, the future buddha, and consists primarily of a series of mantras — including a root mantra, a heart mantra, and a close heart mantra — accompanied by teachings on the great spiritual merit generated by hearing, reading, reciting, or meditating upon them. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of works that preserve sacred formulas believed to protect practitioners and bring about liberation, and it appears immediately following the Noble Mañjuśrī's One Hundred and Eight Names in the canonical arrangement, suggesting its place within a broader collection of short devotional and protective texts.

In this there is no doubt. The Noble Mañjuśrī's One Hundred and Eight Names is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya Maitri Pratijñā Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow of the Noble Maitreya."

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to Maitreya, the Victor.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namō bhagavate Śākyamunaye tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ ajite ajite aparājite ajitañjaya hara hara maitry avalokite kara kara mahāsamayasiddhe bhara bhara mahābodhimaṇḍavīje smara smara asmākaṃ samaya bodhi bodhi mahābodhi svāhā. This is the root mantra.

Oṃ mohi mohi mahāmohi svāhā. This is the heart.

Oṃ muni muni smara svāhā. This is the close heart.

By merely hearing this dhāraṇī, or reading it, or reciting it, or reflecting on it with proper attention, or merely meditating upon it — at that time when I myself become fully and perfectly awakened in unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, I will unfailingly seek out that sentient being and bestow upon them a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Even if it is proclaimed into the ears of deer and birds born in the animal realm, they too shall receive a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

By merely hearing this, one will never again be reborn in the lower realms. One will not be stained by the defilements of the lower realms. One will not be born in a mother's womb. For a thousand divine aeons one will become a wheel-turning king. One will come to possess the path of the ten virtuous actions. Whatever one wishes and seeks, one's wealth and prosperity will be accomplished.

O Blessed One, I will not abandon those sentient beings. Definitely, when I have reached the heart of awakening, no matter what circumstances arise, I will bestow upon them a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

The Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow of the Noble Maitreya" is complete.

The Indian paṇḍita Vajrapāṇi —

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the colophon, ending with "The Indian paṇḍita Vajrapāṇi —" without completing the translator's name and collaborator credit. This is a common colophon formula typically followed by the names of the Indian paṇḍita and the Tibetan lo tsā ba (translator), but the passage as given ends there.

The vow structure throughout is spoken in the first person by Maitreya himself, as a solemn pledge made before the Blessed One (the Buddha). This is doctrinally significant: the dhāraṇī embodies Maitreya's formal commitment to prophesy the awakening of any being who encounters it.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly

proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.
May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.